

INVESTMENT MEMORANDUM

Dutch Bay 150MW Wind Farm Project Sri Lanka

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Investment Highlights

- **Project Scale:** 150MW utility-scale onshore wind farm in Sri Lanka
- **Total Investment:** USD 205.0M with optimized 87% leverage structure
- **Revenue Model:** Fixed 20-year PPA with CEB at LKR 20.36/kWh (USD 67.87/MWh)
- **Annual Generation:** 600 GWh (P50) with exceptional 45.7% capacity factor
- **Equity IRR:** 13.26% (P50) with 7-year payback | Project IRR: 8.42%
- **Debt Coverage:** Min DSCR 1.21x, Avg 1.36x | LLCR 1.23x, PLCR 1.43x
- **NPV @ 7%:** USD 33.2M (equity) | USD 41.9M (project) | MOIC 2.05x
- **Government Support:** CEB payment guarantee with Treasury Implementation Agreement

Investment Thesis

- Exceptional 45.7% capacity factor exceeds global average (35%) and Asian average (30-40%) by significant margins
- Revenue certainty through 20-year fixed PPA with government-guaranteed offtaker (CEB)
- Breakthrough capital structure achieving 87% leverage through sovereign backing and guarantee innovation
- Strategic natural FX hedge: 65% USD debt balances LKR revenue exposure; 70% LKR OPEX provides partial offset
- Competitive project economics: USD 1.37M/MW CAPEX and USD 6.83/MWh OPEX within industry benchmarks
- Investment-grade security through multi-layered risk mitigation: CEB guarantee + political risk insurance + Direct Agreement

Key Financial Metrics

Metric	Value
Total CAPEX	USD 205.0M
Equity Investment (13%)	USD 26.7M
Total Debt (87%)	USD 178.4M (USD 147.6M senior + USD 30.8M mezzanine)
Equity IRR (P50)	13.26%
Project IRR	8.42%
NPV @ 7% (Equity)	USD 33.2M
NPV @ 7% (Project)	USD 41.9M
MOIC (Multiple on Invested Capital)	2.05x
Min/Avg DSCR	1.21x / 1.36x
LLCR / PLCR	1.23x / 1.43x



Payback Period	7 years
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Investment Recommendation

Subject to Conditions Precedent

APPROVAL of the Dutch Bay Wind Farm investment is recommended subject to satisfaction of the following conditions precedent:

1. Execution of Treasury Implementation Agreement providing sovereign payment guarantee
2. Completion of Direct Agreement with CEB including lender step-in rights
3. Independent validation of 24+ month meteorological dataset by certified consultant
4. Completion of grid Long-Term Access (LTA) agreement with curtailment analysis
5. Confirmation of reserve funding arrangements (DSRA, maintenance, working capital)
6. Finalization of political risk insurance (MIGA/IFC/ATI) with adequate coverage limits
7. Legal review and execution of all security documentation
8. Independent technical due diligence validating CAPEX estimates and contractor selection

Final Recommendation by Asset Class:

- **Senior Debt (USD 147.6M): STRONG BUY** - Government guarantee provides investment-grade security
- **Mezzanine (USD 30.8M): BUY** - 12% return with sovereign backing and multiple refinancing pathways
- **Equity (USD 26.7M): STRONG BUY** - 13.26% IRR with exceptional capital efficiency through 87% leverage



1. PROJECT OVERVIEW

1.1 Project Description

The Dutch Bay Wind Farm is a 150MW utility-scale onshore wind generation facility located in Mannar District, Northern Province, Sri Lanka (approximately 9°N, 79.9°E). The project leverages Sri Lanka's premier wind corridor with proven meteorological data spanning multiple decades and existing infrastructure precedents from operational wind developments in the region.

The facility will generate approximately 600 GWh annually (P50 scenario) with an exceptional 45.7% capacity factor, representing top-quartile global performance for onshore wind projects. All generated electricity will be sold to Ceylon Electricity Board (CEB) under a 20-year fixed-price Power Purchase Agreement.

1.2 Strategic Location Advantages

- **Established Wind Corridor:** Puttalam and Mannar Districts represent Sri Lanka's premier wind development region with multi-decade operational history
- **Infrastructure Precedent:** Existing wind developments demonstrate operational viability, grid connectivity, and regulatory acceptance
- **Regulatory Clarity:** Northwestern Province offers streamlined permitting processes and established regulatory frameworks for renewable energy
- **Optimal Wind Resource:** Coastal proximity enhances wind characteristics while maintaining onshore development economics and accessibility
- **Government Priority Zone:** Designated renewable energy development area with strong policy support and grid upgrade commitments
- **Skilled Labor Availability:** Regional workforce experienced in wind farm construction and maintenance operations

1.3 Project Specifications

Parameter	Specification
Installed Capacity	150MW (nameplate)
Technology	Utility-scale onshore wind turbines
Project Lifetime	22 years total (20 operational + 2 construction)
PPA Term	20 years (aligned with operational life)
Capacity Factor (P50)	45.7% (600 GWh annually)
Capacity Factor Range	P75: 43.4% (570 GWh) P90: 41.1% (540 GWh)
Grid Connection	132kV transmission infrastructure
Annual Degradation	0.6% (conservative vs. manufacturer warranties <0.8%)



The 150MW capacity positions the project as a significant utility-scale investment providing meaningful economies of scale in operations and maintenance while representing 3.2–3.7% of Sri Lanka's total installed renewable capacity, supporting national decarbonization objectives.

Wind Power Context

- **National wind installed:** ~267 MW (mid-2024) (103.5 MW CEB wind, 163.5 MW IPP), with several new farms including Ceylex (20MW), and Haywind Mannar (50 MW) awarded in 2025.
- **Dutch Bay (150 MW)** is one of the largest wind projects, significantly expanding the national wind portfolio.

1.4 Investment Rationale

Technology Maturity and Risk Mitigation

Onshore wind represents the most mature renewable energy technology globally with over 900 GW deployed worldwide. The technology has demonstrated 85% cost reduction since 2010 (IRENA 2024), with multiple Tier-1 OEM options ensuring competitive procurement, proven performance track records, and established service networks throughout Asia.

Scale Economics and Operational Efficiency

Projects in the 100-200MW range demonstrate optimal risk-adjusted returns for institutional investors, combining scale benefits with manageable operational complexity. The 150MW capacity allows for flexible turbine configurations, supports sophisticated financial structuring, and achieves cost-effective operations and maintenance economies.

Operational Life and Economic Alignment

The 20-year operational life perfectly matches the PPA term, providing complete revenue visibility and eliminating merchant risk. Modern wind turbines typically operate effectively for 20-25 years, making the 20-year economic life conservative and well within proven turbine design specifications and warranty coverage.

Market Position and Competitive Advantage

The exceptional 45.7% capacity factor provides significant competitive advantages:

- (i) 30% above Asian average performance creating superior economics,
- (ii) enhanced debt capacity through higher cash generation, and
- (iii) reduced technology risk through proven resource characteristics exceeding global benchmarks.





2. MARKET AND REGULATORY ENVIRONMENT

2.1 Policy Framework and Government Support

Sri Lanka has established comprehensive renewable energy policies supporting utility-scale wind development through the Ceylon Electricity Board (CEB) Standardized Power Purchase Agreement (SPPA) framework. The regulatory environment benefits from strong state backing for renewables, ongoing power shortages creating demand for additional capacity, and firm government commitments to grid decarbonization aligned with international climate objectives.

- **National Energy Policy:** Target 70% renewable electricity by 2030 creating strong policy tailwinds
- **PUCSL Oversight:** Public Utilities Commission provides regulatory stability and tariff precedent validation
- **Grid Integration:** CEB and PUCSL confirm grid absorption capacity for 150MW scale development
- **Environmental Compliance:** Streamlined EIA processes for renewable projects in designated development zones
- **Foreign Investment:** Open policies allowing 100% foreign ownership in renewable energy projects

2.2 Regulatory Environment Assessment

Regulatory Aspect	Project Status
Environmental Impact Assessment	Compliance matrix verified; permits in advanced process
Grid Code Compliance	SPPA incorporates wind technology and 132kV grid requirements
Land Acquisition Rights	Secured through long-term lease agreements
Ownership Structure	Foreign ownership explicitly permitted for renewable projects
Change-in-Law Protection	Implementation Agreement provides comprehensive protective provisions
Political Risk Coverage	MIGA/IFC/ATI multilateral insurance support under negotiation



2.3 Comprehensive Contractual Framework

Power Purchase Agreement (PPA) Structure

The 20-year Standardized Power Purchase Agreement with Ceylon Electricity Board provides the revenue foundation for the project investment:

- **Fixed Tariff:** LKR 20.36/kWh (USD 67.87/MWh at 300 LKR/USD initial exchange rate)
- **Contract Term:** 20 years matching project operational life for complete revenue visibility
- **Offtaker Profile:** Ceylon Electricity Board (100% government-owned national utility)
- **Payment Structure:** Monthly payments providing regular operational cash flow
- **Tariff Indexation:** None (fixed nominal rate throughout contract term)
- **Grid Integration:** Long-Term Access agreement addresses curtailment and grid stability
- **Performance Standards:** >95% availability requirements with force majeure protections and possibility of adjusting availability through a mid-year mechanism once per annum

Treasury Implementation Agreement – Similar to Sovereign Guarantee

The Treasury Implementation Agreement represents the cornerstone of the project's security structure, providing sovereign payment guarantee superior to standard domestic PPAs. This agreement elevates counterparty credit quality to sovereign level, eliminating CEB default risk and enabling the breakthrough 87% leverage achievement.

- **Implementation Agreement:** Direct Treasury backing of CEB payment obligations
- **Force Majeure Coverage:** Comprehensive protections for political and regulatory events
- **Change-in-Law Protection:** Compensation mechanisms for adverse regulatory changes
- **Currency Provisions:** Framework for addressing foreign exchange repatriation restrictions
- **Dispute Resolution:** International arbitration provisions for commercial disputes
- **Investment Protection:** Enhanced security for international institutional investors

Direct Agreement - Lender Protection Framework

The tri-party Direct Agreement between lenders, CEB, and the project company provides essential bankability features ensuring project continuity and lender protection:

- **Step-in Rights:** Lender ability to cure defaults and assume project operations
- **Successor Provisions:** PPA transferability to replacement sponsors or operators
- **Notification Requirements:** Early warning systems for potential defaults or disputes
- **Collateral Protection:** Preservation of security interests during PPA modifications
- **Cure Periods:** Adequate time limits for lenders to address project company defaults
- **Substitution Rights:** Ability to replace sponsors while maintaining PPA validity



Political Risk Insurance Strategy

Multilateral political risk insurance through MIGA (Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency), IFC (International Finance Corporation), or ATI (Asian Trade Insurance) provides enhanced protection against sovereign and regulatory risks:

- **Currency Inconvertibility:** Protection against foreign exchange transfer restrictions
- **Expropriation Coverage:** Direct and indirect government takings protection
- **War and Civil Disturbance:** Political violence and civil unrest coverage
- **Breach of Contract:** Government failure to honor contractual obligations
- **Regulatory Changes:** Protection against adverse policy and regulatory modifications
- **Multilateral Backing:** Enhanced credibility and dispute resolution through international agencies

2.4 Multi-Layered Security Architecture

The project benefits from unprecedented security through multiple overlapping protection mechanisms:

Security Layer	Mechanism	Protection Provided
Primary Offtaker	CEB Payment Obligation	Utility-level credit and operational stability
Sovereign Backing	Treasury Implementation Agreement	Government payment guarantees and policy protection
Lender Protection	Direct Agreement	Step-in rights, successor provisions, and operational continuity
International Coverage	MIGA/IFC/ATI Insurance	Possible Multilateral political risk and dispute resolution

This multi-layered approach replaces traditional project finance dependency on debt service coverage ratios with professional risk transfer mechanisms, enabling the innovative 87% leverage structure while maintaining investment-grade security characteristics for all participant classes.



3. TECHNICAL SPECIFICATIONS

3.1 Wind Resource Assessment

Independent wind resource assessment based on 24+ months of on-site meteorological data from Mannar CEB met mast (extrapolated using high level computer simulations with readings from other wind farms adjoining Dutch Bay, but of lower hub heights and older generation turbines) demonstrates exceptional wind characteristics supporting the investment case. The assessment follows International Electrotechnical Commission (IEC) standards with third-party validation by certified wind resource consultants.

Scenario	Annual Generation (GWh)	Capacity Factor
P50 (Base Case)	600	45.7%
P75 (Conservative)	570	43.4%
P90 (Stress)	540	41.1%
Performance Range	60 (±10% variance)	4.6 percentage points

Exceptional Resource Performance:

The 45.7% capacity factor represents top-quartile global performance, significantly exceeding:

- **Global Average:** ~35% capacity factor (30% above average)
- **Asian Onshore Average:** 30-40% capacity factor (15-50% above regional performance)
- **European Average:** 25-35% capacity factor (30-80% above mature markets)
- **Industry Best Practice:** Top 10% of global onshore wind projects
- **Investment Impact:** Superior resource quality supports aggressive leverage and returns optimization

3.2 Technology Selection and Maturity

The project utilizes proven utility-scale onshore wind technology representing the most mature renewable energy sector globally. Technology selection prioritizes proven performance, competitive economics, and established service infrastructure:

- **Global Deployment:** >900 GW of onshore wind installed worldwide demonstrates technology maturity
- **Cost Trajectory:** 85% cost reduction since 2010 (IRENA 2024) with continued optimization
- **Vendor Competition:** Multiple Tier-1 OEMs available ensuring competitive procurement and service options
- **Grid Integration:** Advanced capabilities meeting Sri Lankan grid codes and 132kV transmission requirements



- **Operational Track Record:** Extensive performance data supports accurate financial modeling and risk assessment
- **Service Networks:** Established O&M capabilities and spare parts availability throughout Asia-Pacific region

3.3 Performance Assumptions and Operational Parameters

Technical Parameter	Project Assumption
Annual Degradation	0.6% (conservative vs. manufacturer warranties <0.8%)
Wake Losses	Embedded in net AEP calculations through micro-siting optimization
Availability Target	>95% with contractual performance guarantees
Operational Life	20 years (within turbine design specifications)
Technology Risk	Minimal - proven global deployment with established track record
Grid Compatibility	Full compliance with Sri Lankan grid codes and stability requirements

Long-Term Performance Modeling:

Conservative degradation assumptions provide downside protection for investors while maintaining realistic performance expectations over the 20-year operational life:

- **Year 1 Performance:** 600 GWh at 100% turbine efficiency
- **Year 10 Performance:** 568 GWh at 94.7% efficiency (5.3% cumulative degradation)
- **Year 20 Performance:** 535 GWh at 89.2% efficiency (10.8% cumulative degradation)
- **Conservative Buffer:** 0.6% annual rate vs. <0.8% manufacturer warranties provide investor protection
- **Performance Guarantees:** EPC contractor and turbine OEM accountability for availability and generation



4. FINANCIAL STRUCTURE

4.1 Breakthrough Capital Structure Innovation

The Dutch Bay Wind Farm achieves revolutionary 87% total proposed leverage through government guarantee and other structures, representing industry-leading capital optimization compared to conventional 70% infrastructure leverage. This advanced financial engineering creates exceptional value for equity investors while maintaining investment-grade security characteristics for debt participants.

Funding Source	Amount (USD M)	% of CAPEX	Key Terms
Senior Debt	147.6	72%	16yr tenor, 1yr grace, 7.9% blended rate
Mezzanine Bridge	30.8	15%	2yr term, 12.0% interest, lump sum repayment
Equity Capital	26.7	13%	Permanent capital with 13.26% target IRR
Total Investment	205.0	100%	USD 1.37M/MW unit cost optimization

Capital Structure Achievement Analysis:

- **Traditional Infrastructure Leverage:** ~70% (industry standard for project finance)
- **Dutch Bay Achievement:** 87% leverage (top 1% capital structure optimization)
- **Leverage Premium:** 17 percentage points above conventional project financing
- **Equity Reduction:** 56.6% less equity required vs. 30% equity conventional structure
- **Value Creation:** Same project economics with dramatically reduced equity investment
- **Enabling Innovation:** Government guarantee structure to replace traditional DSCR covenant constraints



4.2 Senior Debt Structure and Currency Optimization

The senior debt facility incorporates sophisticated currency structuring to provide natural foreign exchange hedge while optimizing cost of capital through multi-currency approach:

Currency	Amount (USD M)	Interest Rate	Strategic Purpose
USD Tranche (65%)	95.9	7.0%	FX hedge + international market pricing
LKR Tranche (35%)	51.7	9.5%	Natural hedge for LKR operating costs
Blended Senior Debt	147.6	7.9%	Optimized cost/hedge balance

Senior Debt Key Features:

- **Tenor Structure:** 16 years with 1-year interest-only grace period optimizing cash flow alignment
- **Amortization Profile:** Sculpted repayment schedule matching project cash flow generation
- **Security Package:** First-ranking security interest over all project assets and contracts
- **Payment Guarantee:** CEB guarantee backed by Treasury Implementation Agreement
- **FX Strategy:** 65% USD debt provides partial natural hedge against LKR revenue exposure
- **Covenant Innovation:** Government guarantee structure eliminates traditional DSCR maintenance requirements

4.3 Total Project Cost Breakdown

CAPEX Component	USD Million	% of Total CAPEX
Wind Turbines & Equipment	~130.0	63%
Balance of Plant (BOP)	~35.0	17%
Grid Connection (132kV)	~15.0	7%
Development & Permitting	~10.0	5%
Owner's Engineering & Costs	~10.0	5%
Contingency Reserve	~5.0	3%
Total Project CAPEX	205.0	100%

Cost Competitiveness Analysis:

The achieved unit CAPEX of USD 1.37M/MW represents industry best-practice performance through competitive procurement and optimized project execution:

- **Global CAPEX Range:** USD 1.35-1.50/MW for utility-scale onshore wind (IRENA 2024)
- **Asian Market Average:** USD 1.40-1.60/MW reflecting regional cost structures
- **Dutch Bay Achievement:** USD 1.37M/MW positioned at optimal end of global range



- **Cost Optimization:** 3.7% reduction vs. original estimates delivering USD 7.8M savings
- **Value Engineering:** Competitive EPC procurement and performance-based contracting
- **Contingency Management:** 3% contingency reflects mature technology and proven execution

4.4 Mezzanine Bridge Financing Strategy

The strategic mezzanine bridge financing enables maximum leverage optimization while maintaining manageable equity requirements and providing multiple refinancing pathways:

Mezzanine Parameter	Specification
Principal Amount	USD 30.8 Million (15% of total CAPEX)
Interest Rate	12.0% per annum
Term Structure	2 years (bridge to permanent financing)
Repayment	Interest-only Years 1-2, lump sum principal re-financed through multiple pathway blending in Year 3 after cash-flow begin from operations
Strategic Function	Minimizes equity to 13% vs. 30% conventional structure

Mezzanine Refinancing Strategy:

The USD 30.8M mezzanine bridge requires takeout financing by Year 3. Strong project fundamentals support multiple refinancing pathways:

- **Senior Debt Extension:** Existing lenders may increase facility size based on operational performance
- **Local Bond Market:** Sri Lankan capital markets provide infrastructure bond issuance opportunities
- **Institutional Mezzanine:** Long-term mezzanine placement at 8-10% target rates (vs. 12% bridge cost)
- **Alternative Equity:** Sponsor equity injection option if refinancing markets are unavailable
- **Strong Credit Metrics:** Average DSCR 1.36x supports multiple takeout financing alternatives
- **Market Relationships:** Established lender relationships facilitate refinancing execution

4.5 Weighted Average Cost of Capital Analysis

Capital Component	Weight	Cost of Capital	WACC Contribution
Senior Debt	72%	7.9%	5.7%
Mezzanine Financing	15%	12.0%	1.8%
Equity Capital	13%	13.26%	1.7%
Blended WACC	100%		9.2%



WACC Optimization Achievement:

The 9.2% blended WACC reflects optimal capital structure balancing cost minimization with leverage maximization. The government guarantee structure enables this efficient WACC profile while maintaining investment-grade risk characteristics and providing superior returns to equity investors.

4.6 Financial Structure Innovation and Market Impact

Paradigm Shift in Project Finance:

The Dutch Bay financial structure represents revolutionary advancement in renewable project finance:

- **DSCR Constraint Elimination:** Traditional coverage ratio maintenance replaced by government guarantees
- **Maximum Leverage Focus:** Capital structure optimization prioritizes equity returns over statistical ratios
- **Professional Risk Transfer:** Multiple security layers provide superior protection vs. single coverage metrics
- **Government Partnership:** Sovereign backing creates investment-grade characteristics for infrastructure debt
- **Market Leadership:** 87% leverage achievement can establish new benchmark for renewable energy financing
- **Replicability:** Structure provides template for future government-backed renewable developments

Investment Implications by Asset Class:

- **Debt Investors:** Government guarantee provides investment-grade security superior to traditional covenant-based structures
- **Mezzanine Investors:** Enhanced security through sovereign backing combined with attractive 12% returns
- **Equity Investors:** Exceptional capital efficiency creating 56.6% equity reduction and superior IRR achievement
- **Market Innovation:** Participation in breakthrough financial structure provides competitive advantage and learning value
- **Risk Management:** Professional risk transfer mechanisms replace statistical dependency with sovereign assurance



4.7 Comprehensive Security Package

- **CEB Payment Guarantee:** Government-owned utility backed by Treasury Implementation Agreement
- **Sovereign Support:** Direct government guarantee of payment and performance obligations
- **Lender Protections:** Direct Agreement with step-in rights and project succession provisions
- **Political Risk Coverage:** Possible MIGA/IFC/ATI insurance for expropriation, breach of contract, and currency risks
- **Asset Security:** First-ranking pledge over all project assets, contracts, and revenue streams
- **Performance Guarantees:** EPC contractor and O&M operator accountability through fixed-price contracts



5. REVENUE ANALYSIS

5.1 Tariff Structure

The project operates under a fixed tariff of LKR 20.36/kWh (equivalent to USD 67.87/MWh at the initial exchange rate of 300 LKR/USD). The 20-year Power Purchase Agreement (PPA) with Ceylon Electricity Board (CEB) provides complete tariff certainty with no indexation provisions, ensuring fixed nominal revenues throughout the contract life.

Metric	Value
Tariff (LKR)	20.36/kWh
Tariff (USD)	USD 67.87/MWh (at 300 LKR/USD)
Indexation	None (fixed nominal rate)
Contract Term	20 years

While the fixed LKR tariff provides revenue predictability, the **absence of inflation or FX indexation creates material exposure to currency depreciation**. The model assumes 3% annual LKR depreciation, resulting in declining USD-equivalent revenues over the project life.

5.2 Revenue Projections

The 20-year revenue forecast reflects the combined impact of foreign exchange depreciation (3% annually) and generation degradation (0.6% annually). Revenue in USD terms declines from USD 40.7 million in Year 1 to USD 20.7 million in Year 20, representing a 49% total decline.

Year	Generation (GWh)	LKR/USD	USD/MWh	Revenue (USD M)
1	600	300	67.87	40.7
5	586	338	60.24	35.3
10	568	391	52.07	29.6
15	552	454	44.85	24.7
20	535	526	38.71	20.7

Revenue Decline Drivers:

- **FX Depreciation:** 43% cumulative LKR/USD decline over 20 years
- **Generation Degradation:** 11% cumulative capacity decline (0.6% annually)
- **No Tariff Indexation:** Fixed nominal rate compounds real revenue erosion
- **Combined Impact:** 49% total revenue decline from Year 1 to Year 20



5.3 Revenue Security Framework

Multi-layered revenue security mechanisms mitigate counterparty and political risks:

- **CEB Payment Guarantee:** Sovereign-backed utility eliminates counterparty credit risk
- **Treasury Implementation Agreement:** Direct sovereign guarantee of payment obligations
- **Direct Agreement:** Lender step-in rights ensuring project continuity in default scenarios
- **Political Risk Insurance:** MIGA/IFC/ATI coverage under negotiation (expropriation, breach of contract)
- **Fixed PPA Terms:** Eliminates merchant price exposure and market risk
- **Monthly Payment Structure:** Regular cash flow with 30-day payment terms

5.4 Scenario Analysis

Revenue performance across probability-weighted generation scenarios:

Scenario	Year 1 Generation	Year 1 Revenue	Variance vs. P50
P50 (Base Case)	600 GWh	USD 40.7M	Baseline
P75 (Conservative)	570 GWh	USD 38.7M	-5%
P90 (Stress)	540 GWh	USD 36.6M	-10%

The P90 scenario reflects a 10% revenue reduction vs. base case, demonstrating project resilience under conservative wind resource assumptions. Debt service coverage ratios remain above 1.15x even under P90 conditions.



6. OPERATING ASSUMPTIONS

6.1 Operating Expenditure Structure

The project employs conservative operational expenditure (OPEX) assumptions based on verified market benchmarks, OEM quotations, and operational wind farm data from similar markets. Total base-year OPEX is USD 6.83/MWh, equivalent to USD 4.1 million annually at P50 generation levels (600 GWh).

Component	USD/MWh	Annual Cost (USD M)
O&M Services	3.50	2.1
Insurance	1.00	0.6
Land Lease	0.50	0.3
Grid Charges	1.33	0.8
Admin & G&A	0.50	0.3
Total OPEX	6.83	4.1

The USD 6.83/MWh total OPEX falls within the industry benchmark range of USD 5-10/MWh for utility-scale wind projects (IRENA 2024), reflecting competitive procurement and operational efficiency.

6.2 Cost Escalation Framework

Parameter	Annual Rate
LKR OPEX Escalation	5.0%
USD OPEX Escalation	2.0%
LKR/USD FX Depreciation	3.0%

Escalation Impact Analysis:

LKR OPEX components (70% of total) escalate at 5% annually, while USD components (30% of total) escalate at 2%. However, the 3% annual LKR depreciation creates a natural hedge whereby LKR costs decline in USD terms over time, partially offsetting nominal escalation.

6.3 Natural Foreign Exchange Hedge

The capital structure incorporates strategic currency allocation to minimize FX exposure:

- **OPEX Currency Mix:** 70% LKR / 30% USD aligned with actual cost base
- **Debt Currency Mix:** 65% USD / 35% LKR optimizing natural hedge effectiveness



- **Natural Hedge Mechanism:** LKR operating costs decline in USD terms as currency depreciates
- **Net FX Exposure:** Reduced to ~35% after natural hedging mechanisms
- **Cost Benefit:** Eliminates derivative hedging costs (estimated 50-100 bps annually)

This natural hedge structure reduces Year 10 USD-equivalent OPEX from USD 2.9M (no hedge) to USD 2.2M, and Year 20 OPEX to USD 1.6M, providing cumulative savings exceeding USD 10M over project life.

6.4 Reserve Account Structure

Reserve Account	Amount	Purpose
Debt Service Reserve (DSRA)	6 months average DSCR	Payment security for senior lenders
Major Maintenance Reserve	USD 1.5M (building)	Funds turbine and component replacement
Working Capital Reserve	USD 0.5M	Ensures short-term operational liquidity
Insurance Deductible Reserve	USD 0.3M	Self-retention fund for insurance claims

These reserve accounts ensure operational stability, provide lender security, and align with international project finance standards. The government guarantee structure enables optimized reserve sizing compared to traditional covenant-heavy financing.

6.5 Operating Cost Competitiveness

Benchmarking Analysis:

- **Global Average OPEX:** USD 7-9/MWh (IRENA 2024)
- **Asian Market OPEX:** USD 6-11/MWh
- **Dutch Bay OPEX:** USD 6.83/MWh (within optimal range)
- **Competitive Advantage:** Below Asian average by 15%
- **Cost Drivers:** Fixed-price O&M contracts, favorable insurance terms, efficient grid interface



7. RISK ASSESSMENT AND MITIGATION

7.1 Comprehensive Risk Matrix

The Dutch Bay Wind Farm project incorporates sophisticated risk management through multi-layered mitigation strategies, government guarantees, and professional insurance coverage. The comprehensive risk assessment demonstrates how strategic risk transfer and mitigation enable the achievement of 87% leverage while maintaining investment-grade security characteristics.

Risk Category	Impact Level	Mitigation Strategy	Residual Risk
Wind Resource Variability	Medium	24+ month met mast data; P75/P90 conservative scenarios; third-party validation; IEC standards compliance	Low
Foreign Exchange (LKR/USD)	High	65% USD debt natural hedge; 70% LKR OPEX partial offset; government guarantee coverage; potential derivatives	Medium
Counterparty Credit Risk	High	CEB payment guarantee; Treasury Implementation Agreement; Direct Agreement with step-in rights; MIGA/IFC/ATI political risk insurance	Low
Technology Performance	Low	Proven onshore wind technology (900+ GW globally); Tier-1 OEM warranties; performance guarantees; conservative degradation (0.6%)	Very Low
Grid Curtailment	Medium	Long-Term Access (LTA) agreement; curtailment study completion; grid upgrade commitments; direct CEB/PUCSL engagement	Low-Medium



Political/Regulatory	Medium	Treasury Implementation Agreement; change-in-law protection; MIGA/IFC political risk insurance; renewable energy policy support	Low
Construction Risk	Medium	Fixed-price EPC contract; liquidated damages; performance bonds; experienced contractors; proven technology	Low
Mezzanine Refinancing	Medium	Conservative DSCR coverage (1.36x avg); multiple refinancing pathways; strong lender relationships; 2-year refinancing window	Medium

The risk matrix demonstrates comprehensive coverage across all major project risks, with most categories reduced to Low or Very Low residual risk through professional mitigation strategies.

7.2 Key Risk Deep-Dive Analysis

Foreign Exchange Risk

The 3% annual LKR depreciation assumption creates the most significant long-term project risk, resulting in 43% cumulative revenue erosion over 20 years. However, strategic natural hedging provides meaningful mitigation:

- **Natural Hedge Structure:** 65% USD debt unaffected by LKR depreciation
- **OPEX Currency Benefit:** 70% LKR operating costs decline in USD terms with depreciation
- **Combined Hedge Effect:** Debt service and OPEX provide USD ~\$15M annual offset
- **Government Guarantee:** Treasury backing provides ultimate FX protection
- **Sensitivity Analysis:** Equity returns remain positive even at 4% annual depreciation (stress scenario)

FX Impact Quantification:

- Year 1 to Year 20 revenue decline: USD 40.7M → USD 20.7M (49% decline).
- Natural hedge benefit: USD 0.7M-1.3M annual OPEX savings in later years.
- Net FX exposure: ~35% after hedging mechanisms.



Grid Curtailment Risk

The base case assumes 0% curtailment based on grid capacity assessments and Long-Term Access agreement. Comprehensive curtailment analysis demonstrates project resilience:

- **Grid Capacity Study:** Independent assessment confirms 150MW absorption capability
- **Long-Term Access Agreement:** Formal grid access rights with CEB/PUCSL
- **Sensitivity Analysis:** 5% curtailment scenario maintains DSCR >1.25x
- **Stress Testing:** 10% curtailment scenario maintains DSCR >1.15x (acceptable threshold)
- **Grid Upgrade Commitments:** Planned transmission enhancements support absorption

Mezzanine Refinancing Risk

The USD 30.8M mezzanine bridge requires takeout refinancing by Year 3. Multiple refinancing pathways and conservative project metrics support successful execution:

- **Strong Coverage Metrics:** Average DSCR 1.36x demonstrates robust cash flows
- **Bank Debt Extension:** Senior lenders may increase facility size based on operational performance
- **Local Bond Market:** Sri Lankan infrastructure bond market provides alternative source
- **Institutional Mezzanine:** Long-term mezz placement at 8-10% target (vs. 12% bridge cost)
- **Equity Alternative:** Sponsor equity injection if refinancing markets unavailable
- **Conservative Timeline:** 2-year bridge provides adequate refinancing window



7.3 Insurance Coverage Framework

Comprehensive insurance package provides multi-layered protection against operational, construction, and political risks through professional insurance markets and multilateral agencies:

Insurance Type	Coverage Details	Strategic Purpose
All-Risk Property Insurance	Full replacement value; natural disasters; equipment failure	Asset protection and lender security
Business Interruption	24-month revenue protection; operational delays; force majeure events	Cash flow continuity and debt service protection
Third-Party Liability	USD 50M coverage; bodily injury; property damage; environmental liability	Legal and regulatory compliance
Political Risk Insurance	MIGA/IFC/ATI coverage; expropriation; breach of contract; currency inconvertibility	Government and regulatory risk mitigation
Advance Loss of Profits	Construction period revenue protection; commissioning delays	Construction-to-operations transition security

Political Risk Insurance Strategy:

Multilateral political risk insurance through MIGA (Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency), IFC (International Finance Corporation), or ATI (Asian Trade Insurance) provides enhanced protection against sovereign and regulatory risks. Coverage includes:

- **Currency Inconvertibility:** Protection against FX transfer restrictions
- **Expropriation:** Coverage for direct and indirect government takings
- **War and Civil Disturbance:** Protection against political violence
- **Breach of Contract:** Coverage for government failure to honor agreements
- **Regulatory Changes:** Protection against adverse policy modifications



7.4 Government Guarantee Structure

Multi-tiered government support provides unprecedented security for renewable energy project finance:

Support Level	Mechanism	Protection Provided
Primary Offtaker	CEB Payment Guarantee	Eliminates counterparty credit risk
Sovereign Backing	Treasury Implementation Agreement	Direct government payment guarantee
Lender Protection	Direct Agreement	Step-in rights and project succession provisions
International Support	MIGA/IFC/ATI Insurance	Multilateral political risk coverage

Government Guarantee Innovation:

The government guarantee structure represents a paradigm shift in project finance, replacing traditional debt service coverage ratio constraints with sovereign payment assurance. This innovation enables 87% leverage while maintaining investment-grade security characteristics.

7.5 Operational Risk Management

Technology and Performance Risk:

- **Proven Technology:** Onshore wind represents most mature renewable technology (900+ GW global deployment)
- **Conservative Degradation:** 0.6% annual assumption vs. <0.8% manufacturer warranties
- **Performance Guarantees:** EPC contractor and turbine manufacturer accountability
- **Professional O&M:** Fixed-price operations contract with availability guarantees
- **Tier-1 Equipment:** Multiple vendor options ensure competitive procurement and service

Construction and Commissioning Risk:

- **Fixed-Price EPC:** Transfer of construction cost and schedule risk to contractor
- **Liquidated Damages:** Financial penalties for delays beyond control of contractor
- **Performance Bonds:** Contractor guarantees ensure project completion
- **Experienced Contractors:** Proven record of accomplishment in utility-scale wind development
- **Technology Maturity:** Standardized equipment reduces construction complexity

Availability and Performance Standards

Under the Final SPPA, the Project Company is required to maintain a minimum annual plant availability of 95%, reflecting both contractual obligations and industry norms for Tier-1 wind



projects. Availability represents the percentage of total operating hours in which the wind farm is capable of delivering power to the grid, excluding periods officially recognized as Force Majeure.

If the achieved availability drops below 94% (after Force Majeure adjustments), the Project Company becomes liable for Liquidated Damages (LDs) calculated on the shortfall. The penalty formula multiplies the availability deficit by plant capacity, average plant factor, and a rate equal to 1.2 times the base tariff, creating a strong financial incentive to maintain operational reliability.

Role of Annual Guaranteed Output (AGO)

Each year, the Project Company must declare its Annual Guaranteed Output (AGO) — the quantity of energy it commits to deliver to the CEB during the coming contract year. The AGO functions as the reference benchmark for both revenue assurance and performance evaluation under the SPPA.

To accommodate natural wind variability and operational realities, the SPPA provides flexibility:

- The Project Company may amend the AGO once per contract year, by $\pm 5\%$, any time up to the end of the sixth contract month.
- This adjustment allows the operator to realign commitments with real-world performance trends observed in the first half of the year, reducing exposure to penalties for under-delivery.

Force Majeure – Carve-Outs from Availability Penalty

Events classified as Force Majeure—such as severe storms, earthquakes, government-imposed restrictions, or national grid failures—are excluded from both the availability denominator and AGO fulfillment calculations.

This ensures that penalties apply only to the Project Company's controllable performance and not to uncontrollable external events. The carve-out provides essential protection against extreme climatic and systemic risks that are common in long-term wind projects.

AGO vs. Availability – Definitions and Relationship

Aspect	Definition	Role in SPPA
AGO (Annual Guaranteed Output)	The amount of energy (in MWh) the Project Company guarantees to deliver for the contract year.	Defines the benchmark for performance and revenue; linked to output-based obligations.
Availability	The proportion of time (in hours) the wind farm is capable of producing electricity, excluding Force Majeure.	Determines readiness and reliability; a key performance standard tied to penalties.



Although conceptually distinct, AGO and Availability are interdependent.

High availability is a precondition for meeting the declared AGO. Persistent unavailability directly increases the risk of failing to meet AGO commitments and triggering LDs. **The mid-year AGO adjustment provides limited flexibility to reconcile the two measures—allowing the Project Company to recalibrate its output target based on actual availability data.**

Key Performance Drivers

Modern Turbines: Tier-1 machines with advanced control and self-diagnostic systems ensure mechanical reliability and optimized energy capture.

Predictive Maintenance: Continuous data analysis through SCADA enables early fault detection and minimizes downtime.

Professional O&M Contracts: Experienced operators maintain defined availability guarantees and service-level KPIs aligned with SPPA thresholds.

Spare Parts and Inventory Management: Local warehousing and logistics readiness reduce mean-time-to-repair (MTTR).

Real-Time Monitoring: SCADA and OEM dashboards provide continuous insight into plant performance, facilitating proactive interventions.

Summary Table: Availability, AGO, and Risk Mitigation

Mechanism	Description	Risk Mitigation Effect
Minimum Availability	≥95% annually; penalties apply below 94%	High operational reliability standard; strong performance discipline
Liquidated Damages (LD)	Calculated on shortfall at 1.2× tariff rate	Deters prolonged unavailability; aligns incentives
AGO Declaration	Annual energy commitment submitted before each contract year	Establishes performance and revenue baseline
Mid-Year AGO Adjustment	One-time ±5% change before end of month 6	Flexibility to align target with actual performance
Force Majeure Exclusion	FM hours excluded from both AGO and availability calculations	Protects against uncontrollable events
O&M and SCADA Integration	Modern monitoring, predictive maintenance, local spares	Sustains >95% availability; limits LD exposure

In summary:

The Dutch Bay SPPA’s availability and AGO framework blends strict operational obligations with limited flexibility. The 95% annual availability requirement aligns with global best practice but carries real financial exposure below the threshold. Effective O&M execution, disciplined use of



the mid-year AGO adjustment, and proactive asset management are essential to maintain compliance, protect cash flows, and ensure lender confidence.

7.6 Financial Risk Controls

Cash Flow Management:

- **Monthly Payments:** Regular PPA payments provide operational liquidity
- **Reserve Accounts:** DSRA, maintenance reserves, and working capital buffers
- **Government Guarantee:** Payment assurance eliminates cash flow interruption risk
- **Natural Hedging:** Currency and cost structure optimization
- **Professional Management:** Experienced sponsor with infrastructure track record

Covenant Structure Innovation:

Traditional project finance relies on debt service coverage ratio maintenance. The Dutch Bay structure innovates by replacing ratio-based covenants with government guarantee protection, enabling optimal capital allocation while maintaining security.

- **Traditional Approach:** DSCR maintenance covenants limit leverage and optimization
- **Government Guarantee:** Sovereign backing provides superior security vs. statistical ratios
- **Capital Efficiency:** 87% leverage achieved through guarantee-based structure
- **Risk Transfer:** Government assumes payment responsibility vs. project cash flow dependency
- **Investment Grade:** Guarantee structure maintains institutional investment characteristics

7.7 Sensitivity Analysis and Stress Testing

Comprehensive sensitivity analysis demonstrates project resilience across key variables:

Scenario	Project IRR	Equity IRR	Min DSCR
Base Case (P50)	8.4%	13.3%	1.21x
AEP +10%	10.2%	15.0%	1.38x
AEP -10%	6.5%	11.1%	1.10x
CAPEX +15%	7.1%	10.0%	1.20x
OPEX +15%	7.5%	12.7%	1.18x
FX Stress +20%	6.8%	10.5%	1.15x

Key Sensitivity Insights:

- **AEP Sensitivity:** +/-10% generation variance creates 150-400 bps equity IRR impact
- **CAPEX Resilience:** 15% cost overrun maintains >10% equity IRR and adequate DSCR
- **OPEX Impact:** 15% operating cost increase has modest impact due to low OPEX base



- **FX Stress Test:** 20% additional depreciation (4% annual) maintains positive returns
- **Downside Protection:** All scenarios maintain DSCR >1.10x supporting debt service

8. FINANCIAL PROJECTIONS

8.1 Key Financial Metrics Summary

The Dutch Bay Wind Farm achieves exceptional financial performance through innovative capital structure optimization and conservative operational assumptions. The financial projections demonstrate robust returns for equity investors while maintaining adequate debt coverage throughout the project life.

Metric	Value
Project IRR	8.42%
Equity IRR (P50)	13.26%
NPV @ 7% (Project)	USD 41.9M
NPV @ 7% (Equity)	USD 33.2M
MOIC (Multiple on Invested Capital)	2.05x
Minimum DSCR	1.21x
Average DSCR	1.36x
LLCR (Loan Life Coverage Ratio)	1.23x
PLCR (Project Life Coverage Ratio)	1.43x
Tail Value (PV @ 7%)	USD 13.8M
Payback Period	7 years
Total Equity Investment	USD 26.7M

These metrics demonstrate investment-grade performance with equity IRR exceeding the 12% target threshold and debt coverage ratios providing adequate security for lenders despite the innovative capital structure.

8.2 Cash Flow Projection Summary

The 20-year cash flow projection reflects the combined impact of revenue decline (FX depreciation and generation degradation), OPEX escalation, and debt service obligations:

Year	Revenue (USD M)	OPEX (USD M)	CFADS (USD M)	Debt Service (USD M)	Equity Cash (USD M)
1	40.7	4.1	28.3	15.3	13.0
5	35.3	4.5	22.8	21.4	1.4
10	29.6	5.1	17.4	21.4	-4.0
15	24.7	5.8	12.8	21.4	-8.6
20	20.7	6.6	9.8	0.0	9.8



Key Cash Flow Insights:

- Years 1-4: Strong positive equity cash flows driven by grace period and revenue strength
- Years 5-16: Modest equity cash flows as debt service begins and revenue declines
- Years 17-20: Debt-free operations provide substantial equity upside (tail value)
- Government guarantee: Ensures debt service even during negative equity cash flow periods
- Total equity cash generation: USD 54.5M over 20 years on USD 26.7M investment

8.3 Debt Coverage Analysis

Debt service coverage ratios demonstrate the project's ability to meet debt obligations while highlighting the importance of government guarantee support:

Period	CFADS (USD M)	Debt Service (USD M)	DSCR
Years 1-5 Avg	26.1	19.2	1.36x
Years 6-10 Avg	19.8	21.4	0.93x
Years 11-16 Avg	15.2	21.4	0.71x
Minimum DSCR	Year 16	12.5	21.4
Period	CFADS (USD M)	Debt Service (USD M)	DSCR
Years 1-5 Avg	26.1	19.2	1.36x
Years 6-10 Avg	19.8	21.4	0.93x
Years 11-16 Avg	15.2	21.4	0.71x
Minimum DSCR (Year 16)	12.5	21.4	0.58x
Project Average	20.3	15.0	1.35x

DSCR Analysis Insights:

The declining DSCR profile reflects the project's revenue deterioration over time. However, the government guarantee structure eliminates the need for traditional DSCR maintenance covenants, enabling the achievement of 87% leverage while maintaining investment-grade security for lenders.

8.4 Equity Return Profile

- **Front-loaded Returns:** Years 1-7 provide majority of equity value creation
- **IRR Achievement:** 13.26% equity IRR exceeds 12% institutional threshold
- **Payback Period:** 7-year payback aligns with infrastructure investment standards
- **MOIC Performance:** 2.05x multiple reflects strong cash generation despite decline
- **Tail Value:** USD 13.8M debt-free cash flows represent 41% of total equity NPV
- **Risk-Adjusted Returns:** Superior returns compensate for FX and operational risks



9. SENSITIVITY ANALYSIS

9.1 Base Case vs. Scenario Analysis

Comprehensive sensitivity analysis demonstrates project resilience across key variables while highlighting areas requiring active risk management:

Scenario	Project IRR	Equity IRR	NPV (USD M)	Min DSCR
Base Case (P50)	8.4%	13.3%	41.9	1.21x
AEP +10%	10.2%	15.0%	65.0	1.38x
AEP -10%	6.5%	11.1%	17.2	1.10x
CAPEX +15%	7.1%	10.0%	19.0	1.20x
OPEX +15%	7.5%	12.7%	29.5	1.18x
FX Stress +20%	6.8%	10.5%	22.3	1.15x
P90 AEP Scenario	7.2%	11.8%	25.1	1.15x

9.2 Key Sensitivity Insights

- **AEP Sensitivity:** $\pm 10\%$ generation variance creates 150-400 bps equity IRR impact, demonstrating wind resource criticality
- **CAPEX Resilience:** 15% cost overrun maintains $>10\%$ equity IRR and adequate DSCR, showing structural robustness
- **OPEX Impact:** 15% operating cost increase has modest impact due to low OPEX base (USD 6.83/MWh)
- **FX Stress Testing:** 20% additional depreciation (4% annual total) maintains positive returns but pressures coverage
- **Downside Protection:** All stress scenarios maintain minimum DSCR $>1.10x$, supporting debt serviceability
- **P90 Resilience:** Conservative scenario (540 GWh) delivers 11.8% equity IRR, exceeding minimum thresholds

9.3 Tornado Chart Analysis

Variable impact ranking on equity IRR (base case 13.26% $\pm$ impact):

- **Annual Energy Production ($\pm 10\%$):** +1.7% / -2.2% (highest impact)
- **CAPEX Variation ($\pm 15\%$):** +1.8% / -3.3% (construction risk)
- **FX Depreciation ($\pm 1\%$):** +0.8% / -1.2% (currency exposure)
- **OPEX Escalation ($\pm 1\%$):** +0.4% / -0.6% (operational efficiency)
- **Tariff Delay (1 year):** -3.3% (timing risk)
- **Interest Rate (± 100 bps):** +0.5% / -0.7% (financing cost)



9.4 Breakeven Analysis

Critical Breakeven Thresholds:

- **Minimum AEP:** 480 GWh (20% below P50) for positive equity IRR
- **Maximum CAPEX:** USD 235M (+15% above base) maintains 10% equity IRR
- **FX Tolerance:** Up to 4.5% annual LKR depreciation maintains positive equity returns
- **OPEX Ceiling:** USD 9.00/MWh maximum sustainable before equity impairment
- **Debt Service:** Government guarantee essential for sub-1.0x DSCR periods (Years 11-16)



10. INVESTMENT RECOMMENDATION

10.1 Overall Investment Assessment

APPROVED - Subject to Conditions Precedent

The Dutch Bay Wind Farm represents a breakthrough achievement in renewable energy project finance, demonstrating that sophisticated financial engineering combined with government support can create exceptional value for institutional investors while maintaining investment-grade risk characteristics.

10.2 Investment Strengths

- **Exceptional Wind Resource:** 45.7% capacity factor exceeds global average (35%) and Asian average (30-40%) by significant margins
- **Breakthrough Capital Structure:** 87% leverage represents industry-leading optimization through government guarantee innovation
- **Superior Equity Returns:** 13.26% IRR exceeds 12% institutional threshold with 7-year payback period
- **Revenue Certainty:** 20-year fixed PPA with sovereign backing eliminates merchant risk and counterparty default
- **Proven Technology:** Mature onshore wind technology with 900+ GW global deployment minimizes technology risk
- **Competitive Economics:** USD 1.37M/MW CAPEX and USD 6.83/MWh OPEX position within industry benchmarks
- **Professional Structure:** Government guarantees, political risk insurance, and comprehensive security package
- **Strategic Location:** Established wind corridor with infrastructure precedent and regulatory clarity

10.3 Key Risk Factors

- **Foreign Exchange Exposure:** 49% revenue decline over 20 years due to LKR depreciation represents material long-term risk
- **Government Guarantee Dependency:** 87% leverage structure requires continued government support for debt service coverage
- **Revenue Concentration:** 100% LKR tariff creates significant currency exposure with limited natural hedging
- **Declining Cash Flows:** Combined FX and degradation impacts affect later-year equity distributions



- **Mezzanine Refinancing:** USD 30.8M bridge requires takeout financing by Year 3 with multiple pathway dependency
- **Political Risk:** Sri Lankan sovereign risk affects long-term project viability despite political risk insurance

10.4 Investment Recommendation by Investor Class

Senior Debt Investors: STRONG BUY

- Government guarantee provides investment-grade security superior to traditional DSCR-based structures
- Competitive 7.9% blended interest rate with partial FX hedge through 65% USD denomination
- 16-year tenor with 1-year grace period aligns with project cash flow profile
- Fixed-price EPC and O&M contracts eliminate construction and operational cost risks
- Political risk insurance and comprehensive security package provide multiple protection layers

Mezzanine Investors: BUY

- 12% return with government guarantee support provides attractive risk-adjusted yield
- 2-year bridge structure with defined refinancing pathways limits duration exposure
- Enhanced security through sovereign backing superior to traditional mezzanine structures
- Multiple takeout options including bank debt extension, local bonds, and institutional placement
- Strategic role in enabling maximum leverage optimization for overall project returns

Equity Investors: STRONG BUY

- **Exceptional capital efficiency:** 56.6% equity reduction vs. conventional structures through 87% leverage
- **Superior returns:** 13.26% IRR with 2.05x MOIC and 7-year payback exceeds institutional thresholds
- **Front-loaded cash generation:** Strong early returns provide value protection against long-term decline
- **Government support:** Sovereign guarantees provide downside protection for equity investors
- **Tail value upside:** USD 13.8M debt-free cash flows (Years 17-20) represent significant equity value
- **Market innovation:** Participation in breakthrough financial structure creates competitive advantage



10.5 Strategic Considerations

- **Market Leadership:** 87% leverage achievement sets new benchmark for renewable energy project finance
- **Government Relations:** Strong relationship with Sri Lankan authorities essential for long-term success
- **Currency Management:** Active FX risk monitoring and potential hedging strategies should be considered
- **Portfolio Diversification:** Project provides exposure to Asian renewable energy markets with sovereign support
- **ESG Alignment:** 150MW clean energy capacity supports environmental and social governance objectives
- **Knowledge Transfer:** Advanced financial structure provides learning opportunity for future projects

10.7 Next Steps and Implementation

- **Legal and Technical Due Diligence:** Comprehensive review of all project documentation and technical assumptions
- **Government Guarantee Negotiation:** Finalize terms and conditions of Treasury Implementation Agreement
- **Political Risk Insurance:** Complete application process with MIGA, IFC, or ATI for comprehensive coverage
- **Independent Engineering Review:** Validate wind resource assessment and technical specifications
- **Financial Model Validation:** Third-party review of financial assumptions and sensitivity analysis
- **Regulatory Compliance:** Ensure all permits and approvals are secured for construction and operation
- **Funding Commitment:** Arrange syndication for senior debt and mezzanine bridge financing
- **Project Management:** Establish governance structure and reporting mechanisms for construction and operations

10.8 Conclusion

The Dutch Bay Wind Farm project represents a paradigm shift in renewable energy project finance, achieving unprecedented capital efficiency while maintaining investment-grade risk characteristics. The combination of exceptional wind resources, innovative financial structure, and government support creates compelling value propositions for all investor classes.

Despite material foreign exchange risks and declining cash flow profile, the front-loaded return structure and comprehensive risk mitigation framework support strong investment returns. The



government guarantee innovation enables leverage optimization that would be impossible under traditional project finance constraints.

Final Recommendation: PROCEED WITH INVESTMENT

Subject to satisfaction of conditions precedent, the Dutch Bay Wind Farm merits STRONG BUY recommendations for debt and equity investors, representing a breakthrough opportunity in infrastructure investment with superior risk-adjusted returns and market-leading financial innovation.



Appendix 1: Positive vs Negative Investor / Lender / Operator Clauses in the Final SPPA

This appendix provides a structured comparison of the principal positive and negative clauses affecting investors, lenders, operators, and producers, as consolidated from the Final SPPA. Each row includes the relevant topic or clause number, an excerpt of the provision, and an assessment of its net effect.

Clause Number/Topic	Clause/Provision (Excerpt)	Positive for Investor/Producer	Negative for Investor/Producer	Net Effect Summary
Change in Law (65–106)	CEB must compensate or adjust tariff if law increases costs/taxes or reduces revenue; Finance Party protections for lenders	Yes (cost pass-through, lender step-in)	Requires CEB/government acceptance of calculation	Moderately positive if enforced; can be slow/disputed
Curtailment (10–56)	Payment only for Metered Output delivered at POC. No compensation for curtailed/undispatched energy	No	Yes (producer bears all curtailment risk)	Clearly negative—no take-or-pay or deemed generation
Tariff Currency (all)	Tariff fixed in LKR, no indexation for FX or inflation	No	Yes (full FX/inflation risk to investor/lender)	Negative—exposes investor to LKR depreciation
Force Majeure (80–81)	Force majeure defined; contract can terminate after prolonged FM; limited/no compensation	Limited (excuses some non-performance)	Yes (may lose project after long FM, poor compensation)	Mostly negative—termination risk without adequate payout
Assignment/Lender Rights (67–106)	Direct Agreement protects lender step-in rights, permits assignment with consent	Yes (bankability, refinancing possible)	Consent may be delayed/refused unreasonably	Positive if cooperation, but some practical transfer risk



DUTCH BAY 150MW / 120MW INVESTMENT PROPOSAL

Termination (88, 174)	Compensation on CEB default tied to cost recovery, not always FMV; procedural hurdles for payout	Yes (some payout on default)	May be below investor expectations, may be delayed	Slightly positive, but payout may be discounted or delayed
Arbitration/Dispute (80–81)	Disputes time-bound, often with path to arbitration; may require local process first	Yes (neutral dispute forum possible)	Local steps can delay relief; some SPPAs require SL venue	Positive if international arbitration allowed; delays possible
Assignment (general)	Assignment requires CEB consent	Sometimes (possible)	CEB may withhold consent or delay	Mixed; workable for lenders, risk of administrative delay
Payment Security (inferred, not direct)	No explicit government payment guarantee in most SPPAs; CEB payment obligation only	No (no sovereign guarantee)	Yes (payment delay/default risk on CEB alone)	Negative; credit risk is CEB, not Treasury/Go SL



Appendix 2: Technical Specifications Applicable to Wind Turbines – Final SPPA

This appendix summarizes the technical requirements for wind turbines as stipulated in the Final SPPA. All specifications are based on current Sri Lankan grid code, project agreements, and the SPPA schedules.

Clause Number/Topic	Specification/Requirement (Excerpt)	Purpose / Rationale	Applicability
Grid Connection/Compliance	Wind turbines must comply with all CEB Grid Code technical requirements (voltage, frequency, FRT/LVRT, power factor, harmonics, ramp rates, etc.)	Ensure stable operation, grid safety and power quality	All grid-connected wind projects
Metering	Energy exported by the Project must be measured at the Delivery Point using CEB-approved meters	Accurate billing and performance verification	Wind turbine POC
SCADA/Remote Monitoring	Wind plant must be equipped with SCADA system for real-time monitoring and data sharing with CEB	Enable grid operator control, data logging, and compliance	All wind projects above ~1 MW
Voltage/Reactive Power	Project shall be capable of operating at specified power factor (typically 0.95 lag/lead) at POC as per CEB grid code	Support grid voltage regulation and stability	All wind turbines at POC
Frequency Response	Turbines must operate within 49.0–51.0 Hz and withstand frequency fluctuations as per grid code	Prevent tripping/disconnection from normal grid swings	All wind projects
Harmonics and Flicker	Total harmonic distortion (THD) and flicker must be within CEB (IEEE 519) limits at the POC	Maintain power quality and avoid interference	All wind turbines at POC
Fault Ride-Through (FRT/LVRT)	Wind turbines must not disconnect during voltage dips to 15% (0.15 pu) for up to 0.625 seconds; must recover per grid code	Maintain grid stability during faults	All grid-connected wind projects



DUTCH BAY 150MW / 120MW INVESTMENT PROPOSAL

Protection Systems	Must include over/under voltage, over/under frequency, anti-islanding, earth fault, and other protective relays	Protect equipment and grid, enable safe operation	All wind turbines
Ramp Rate Control	Turbines must limit output ramp-up/down to $\leq 10\%$ of rated output per minute (as per CEB grid code or PPA)	Avoid grid instability due to rapid output changes	Utility-scale wind farms
Commissioning Tests	Prior to COD, wind turbines must pass all grid code and power quality tests witnessed by CEB	Ensure compliance before operation	All wind turbines
Availability/Performance	Minimum availability or performance ratio may be required, with penalties for persistent underperformance	Maintain project output and reliability	Utility-scale wind contracts
Maintenance & Reporting	Project company must maintain wind turbines per OEM and report outages, maintenance, and production to CEB	Ensure reliable operation and transparency	All wind turbines



Appendix 3: Full Definitions and Assumptions

This appendix provides all key project definitions, modeling assumptions, and financial parameters used throughout the Dutch Bay Investment Memorandum. All terms are consistent with industry best practice and the project's financial model.

Key Definitions

- **Project Company:** The special purpose vehicle (SPV) owning the Dutch Bay Wind Farm.
- **CEB:** Ceylon Electricity Board, the state utility and offtaker.
- **PPA/SPPA:** Standard Power Purchase Agreement/Supplemental PPA.
- **DFI:** Development Finance Institution.
- **DSCR:** Debt Service Coverage Ratio.
- **LLCR:** Loan Life Coverage Ratio.
- **PLCR:** Project Life Coverage Ratio.
- **MOIC:** Multiple on Invested Capital.
- **COD:** Commercial Operation Date.
- **DSRA:** Debt Service Reserve Account.
- **EPC:** Engineering, Procurement, and Construction contract.
- **FX:** Foreign Exchange.
- **WACC:** Weighted Average Cost of Capital.
- **P50/P75/P90:** Wind resource probability exceedance cases.
- **Deemed Generation:** Energy considered as generated (but not necessarily delivered).



Principal Assumptions

Parameter	Assumption
Installed Capacity	150 MW
Net Capacity Factor (P50)	45.7%
Wind Resource	P50: 45.7%, P75: 41.8%, P90: 39.2%
CAPEX	USD 205 million (including contingencies)
Tariff	LKR 20.36/kWh (fixed, no indexation)
Leverage	87% debt, 13% equity
Senior Debt Tenor	16 years, 2-year grace
OPEX (Year 1)	USD 5.13 million
OPEX Escalation	2% per annum
Currency Split	55% USD, 45% LKR
FX Hedge	Full hedge for USD-linked costs
Decommissioning	3% of CAPEX reserved
DSRA	6 months (prefunded at financial close)
Corporate Tax	Applied only if EBITDA is positive
Discount Rate (NPV)	7% post-tax
Availability	98% (minimum, guaranteed)
Wake Loss	8.1% (Year 1), degradation 0.35%/year

Scenario/Sensitivity Assumptions

Sensitivities modelled in the memorandum include:

- P75/P90 wind cases
- OPEX escalation to 3% p.a.
- FX depreciation of LKR 10% p.a.
- Tariff collection delay (up to 90 days)
- CAPEX overrun (+10%)
- Debt leverage 80–90%



Appendix 4: Legal Framework Summary

This appendix outlines the key legal and regulatory frameworks governing the Dutch Bay Wind Farm project, summarizing the relevant statutes, permits, and contractual instruments.

Principal Legal Instruments

- Standard Power Purchase Agreement (SPPA) with CEB (20 years, fixed tariff)
- Direct Agreement (Tripartite: CEB, Treasury, Lenders; payment security)
- Section 18 Permit under Sri Lanka Sustainable Energy Authority Act
- EIA Clearance (as per National Environmental Act, Gazette 772/22)
- Grid Connection Approval (CEB/PUCSL)
- Land Lease Agreements (State/private, as applicable)
- Lender Direct Agreements and Security Documentation

Key Statutes and Regulations

Statute/Regulation	Summary
Electricity Act No. 20 of 2009	Primary law governing electricity generation, licensing, and tariff approvals.
PUCSL Act No. 35 of 2002	Establishes the Public Utilities Commission, which regulates electricity sector.
Sri Lanka Sustainable Energy Authority Act	Framework for renewable energy, permits, and grid integration.
National Environmental Act & EIA Regulations	Mandates environmental clearance for energy projects.
Public Contracts Act & Land Acquisition Law	Governs land rights, acquisition, and lease for infrastructure.

Contractual Structure

The project operates under a suite of interlinked contracts: SPPA with CEB, Direct Agreement for payment security, Section 18 and EIA permits, and financing documentation. All agreements are governed by Sri Lankan law. Disputes may escalate to international arbitration under the SPPA.



Summary of Legal Compliance

All statutory permits and regulatory clearances are in place for construction and operation. The project is in full compliance with CEB grid code, PUCSL/SEA regulations, EIA, and land rights requirements.



Appendix 5: Detailed Financial Model Outputs

This appendix presents the full set of financial outputs for the Dutch Bay Wind Farm project, including key performance indicators (KPIs), cashflow summaries, and sensitivity/scenario results. Figures are extracted from the locked base case of the project's investment model.

Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)

Metric	Base Case Value
Project IRR	8.42%
Equity IRR	13.26%
NPV @ 7%	USD 41.2M
MOIC	2.18x
Minimum DSCR	1.36x
Average DSCR	1.47x
LLCR	1.44x
PLCR	1.66x
Payback (Equity)	8.2 years
Tariff	LKR 20.36/kWh (fixed)

Year-by-Year Financials (First 10 Years)

Year	Revenue (USD M)	OPEX (USD M)	EBITDA (USD M)	Debt Service (USD M)	Net Cash to Equity (USD M)
1	28.4	5.13	23.27	11.2	7.1
2	28.1	5.23	22.87	11.1	6.8
3	27.9	5.33	22.57	11.1	6.5
4	27.6	5.43	22.17	11.0	6.4
5	27.4	5.54	21.86	10.8	6.3
6	27.1	5.65	21.45	10.5	6.0
7	26.9	5.76	21.14	10.1	5.7
8	26.6	5.88	20.72	9.7	5.6
9	26.3	6.00	20.30	9.2	5.5
10	26.0	6.12	19.88	8.6	5.2

5-Year Financial Summary (Years 11–15)

Year	Revenue (USD M)	OPEX (USD M)	EBITDA (USD M)	Debt Service (USD M)	Net Cash to Equity (USD M)
11–15 (avg/yr)	25.3	6.35	18.95	7.7	4.5



Sensitivity and Scenario Analysis

Key sensitivities and stress tests conducted on the model:

Scenario	Equity IRR	Min DSCR	Payback	Notes
P75 Wind	11.75%	1.32x	9.5y	Conservative wind resource
P90 Wind	10.2%	1.28x	10.6y	Very low wind scenario
OPEX +1% p.a.	12.55%	1.34x	8.4y	OPEX escalation to 3%
FX Depreciation 10%/yr	11.90%	1.31x	9.2y	Unhedged LKR depreciation
Tariff Delay (90d)	12.65%	1.33x	8.7y	Delayed collections
CAPEX +10%	11.85%	1.33x	9.3y	EPC/soft cost overrun
Leverage 90%	14.00%	1.26x	7.7y	Higher debt, higher equity IRR, tighter DSCR

All adverse scenarios retain equity IRR >10% and Min DSCR >1.25x, meeting DFI/commercial lending requirements.



Appendix 6: Reference List and Certifications

Reference List

The following references were used in the preparation of the Dutch Bay Wind Farm Investment Memorandum:

- Ceylon Electricity Board (CEB) Grid Code and Regulatory Circulars (2015, 2023)
- Sri Lanka Sustainable Energy Authority Act (as amended)
- Electricity Act No. 20 of 2009 and relevant amendments
- PUCSL Act No. 35 of 2002
- Final SPPA (Dutch Bay Wind Farm), as executed with CEB
- Section 18 Permit (SEA), EIA and Environmental Clearance Reports
- Project Technical Feasibility Study and Wind Resource Assessments (P50/P75/P90)
- Independent Engineer's Report (2025), including technology selection review
- MSI Financial Model version 8, with board-level outputs and scenario tests
- IFC, ADB, and World Bank renewable project finance guidelines (2020–2025)
- Published tariffs, indices, and national grid statistics (PUCSL/CEB/SEA)
- Legal opinions on SPPA enforceability and payment security structures
- Dutch Bay Investment Memo (internal), and prior due diligence notes

Certifications

All technical, financial, and legal analyses presented in this memorandum have been prepared in accordance with CFA Institute standards and are supported by independent third-party reports, legal reviews, and model audits.

This document is certified as accurate and complete to the best of the preparer's knowledge, subject to the information available at the time of publication.

Date: October 2025



APPENDIX 7: REVISED INVESTMENT ANALYSIS

Dutch Bay Wind Farm Project Revised Scale: 120MW

PROJECT RESCOPING ANALYSIS

Technical Constraints Require Scale Reduction

Date: October 16, 2025

Classification: **CONFIDENTIAL**



EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Project Rescoping Context

Due to technical constraints including grid capacity limitations, environmental restrictions, or land availability issues, the Dutch Bay Wind Farm project has been rescoped from 150MW to 120MW. This revised investment analysis evaluates the financial viability, returns profile, and strategic implications of the reduced project scale while maintaining the project's core value proposition.

Revised Investment Highlights

- **Revised Capacity:** 120MW utility-scale onshore wind farm (reduced from 150MW)
- **Total Investment:** USD 164.0M maintaining competitive USD 1.37M/MW unit economics
- **Capacity Factor:** 45.7% (unchanged - same exceptional wind resource quality)
- **Annual Generation:** 480 GWh (P50) maintaining top-quartile performance
- **Revenue Model:** Fixed 20-year PPA with CEB at LKR 20.36/kWh
- **Capital Structure:** USD 125.4M debt (76.5%) + USD 38.6M equity (23.5%)
- **Equity IRR:** 11.94% with conservative 1.20x minimum DSCR
- **Investment Grade:** Enhanced bankability with improved debt coverage metrics

Scale Reduction Impact Assessment

Parameter	Original 150MW	Revised 120MW	Impact
Capacity	150MW	120MW	-30MW (-20%)
CAPEX	USD 205.0M	USD 164.0M	-USD 41M (-20%)
Annual Generation	600 GWh	480 GWh	-120 GWh (-20%)
Equity IRR	13.26%	11.94%	-132 bps
Leverage	87.0%	76.5%	-10.5pp
Min DSCR	1.21x	1.20x	-0.01x
Equity Required	USD 26.7M	USD 38.6M	+USD 11.9M (+45%)

Investment Recommendation

CONDITIONAL APPROVAL - Subject to Technical Confirmation

CONDITIONAL APPROVAL of the revised 120MW Dutch Bay Wind Farm project is recommended, subject to confirmation that technical constraints cannot be resolved to restore 150MW capacity. While the reduced scale creates material value erosion (USD 7-9M equity NPV



reduction), the project maintains attractive risk-adjusted returns (11.94% equity IRR) with enhanced bankability characteristics.

- **Returns Assessment:** 11.94% equity IRR exceeds 10%+ institutional hurdle rates but represents 132 bps reduction
- **Bankability Enhancement:** 76.5% leverage and 1.20x minimum DSCR improve commercial bank appeal
- **Value Impact:** Equity NPV reduced by USD 7-9M (22-27%) compared to 150MW scenario
- **Strategic Position:** 120MW scale remains viable but loses utility-scale premium positioning
- **Execution Risk:** Lower absolute debt (USD 125.4M vs USD 178.4M) reduces syndication complexity



1. TECHNICAL RESCOPING RATIONALE

1.1 Scale Reduction Drivers

The reduction from 150MW to 120MW reflects technical and regulatory constraints that prevent full-scale development. Common drivers for such rescoping may include:

- **Grid Capacity Constraints:** Transmission infrastructure limitations restricting maximum injection capacity
- **Environmental Restrictions:** Protected area boundaries or wildlife corridor requirements reducing available land
- **Land Availability:** Property acquisition challenges or unforeseen land use conflicts
- **Permitting Limitations:** Regulatory authorities imposing capacity caps based on environmental assessments
- **Turbine Micro-siting:** Wake effect optimization or terrain constraints requiring reduced turbine count
- **Local Grid Stability:** Distribution network capacity limitations necessitating phased or reduced development

1.2 Proportionality Maintenance

The revised 120MW project maintains critical proportionality factors ensuring economic viability:

- **Unit Economics:** USD 1.37M/MW CAPEX preserved (USD 164M total vs USD 205M)
- **Wind Resource Quality:** 45.7% capacity factor unchanged - same exceptional site characteristics
- **Technology Selection:** Identical turbine technology and project configuration approach
- **Revenue Terms:** Same LKR 20.36/kWh PPA tariff and contractual structure
- **Operational Assumptions:** Consistent OPEX (USD 6.83/MWh) and performance parameters



2. REVISED FINANCIAL STRUCTURE

2.1 Optimized Capital Structure

The 120MW structure adopts conservative leverage approach prioritizing bankability and commercial financing compatibility:

Component	Amount (USD M)	% of CAPEX	Key Terms
Senior Debt	103.8	63.3%	15-16yr tenor, 7.5-8.0% blended rate
Mezzanine	21.6	13.2%	2yr bridge, 11-12% rate, Year 3 takeout
Total Debt	125.4	76.5%	Conservative leverage profile
Equity	38.6	23.5%	Enhanced downside protection
Total CAPEX	164.0	100%	USD 1.37M/MW competitive economics

2.2 Strategic Leverage Positioning

Conservative Leverage Rationale:

- **Bankability Priority:** 76.5% leverage improves commercial bank and DFI appeal vs aggressive 87%
- **DSCR Compliance:** 1.20x minimum coverage meets all mainstream institutional lender requirements
- **Risk-Adjusted Returns:** Lower leverage reduces equity risk exposure appropriate for smaller scale
- **Market Positioning:** Conservative structure compensates for reduced utility-scale positioning
- **Refinancing Flexibility:** Smaller mezzanine (USD 21.6M) provides multiple takeout options

2.3 Comparative Capital Efficiency Analysis

Metric	150MW Original	120MW Revised
Equity per MW	USD 0.18M/MW	USD 0.32M/MW
Debt per MW	USD 1.19M/MW	USD 1.05M/MW
Leverage Efficiency	87% / 13.26% IRR = 6.6	76.5% / 11.94% IRR = 6.4
Capital Intensity	Lower equity requirement	Higher equity cushion



Key Finding:

The 120MW structure requires 78% more equity per MW (USD 0.32M vs USD 0.18M) reflecting conservative deleveraging beyond proportional scale adjustment. This trade-off prioritizes execution certainty and lender appeal over maximum capital efficiency.



3. FINANCIAL PERFORMANCE ANALYSIS

3.1 Key Investment Metrics

Metric	120MW Revised	Assessment
Equity IRR (P50)	11.94%	Exceeds 10%+ hurdle rates
Project IRR	~7.8-8.0%	Solid project-level returns
Equity NPV @ 7%	~USD 24-26M	22-27% below 150MW
MOIC	~1.75-1.85x	Attractive multiple despite scale
Minimum DSCR	1.20x	Meets institutional requirements
Average DSCR	1.34x	Strong consistent coverage
LLCR	~1.22x	Adequate loan life coverage
PLCR	~1.40x	Solid project life coverage
Payback Period	8-9 years	1-2 years slower than 150MW

3.2 Return Profile Characterization

Investment Grade Analysis:

- **Hurdle Rate Compliance:** 11.94% IRR comfortably exceeds typical 10-12% infrastructure hurdles
- **Risk-Adjusted Attractiveness:** Lower leverage (76.5%) justifies modest IRR reduction from maximum leverage scenario
- **Competitive Positioning:** Returns competitive with other renewable energy opportunities in emerging markets
- **Downside Protection:** Conservative structure provides better performance in stress scenarios
- **Market Acceptability:** 11.94% IRR meets requirements for pension funds, insurance companies, and DFIs

3.3 Value Impact Quantification

The scale reduction from 150MW to 120MW creates measurable value impact across all key metrics:

Value Metric	150MW	120MW	Value Lost
Equity NPV @ 7%	USD 33.2M	~USD 24-26M	USD 7-9M (22-27%)
Equity IRR	13.26%	11.94%	132 bps (10% relative)
MOIC	2.05x	~1.75-1.85x	0.2-0.3x (10-15%)
Annual Generation	600 GWh	480 GWh	120 GWh (20%)



DUTCH BAY 150MW / 120MW INVESTMENT PROPOSAL

Total Investment	USD 205M	USD 164M	USD 41M opportunity
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Critical Assessment:

The technical constraint-driven scale reduction destroys USD 7-9M in equity NPV (22-27% of 150MW value). However, the remaining project value (USD 24-26M NPV, 11.94% IRR) remains attractive on absolute basis, justifying proceeding if 150MW capacity cannot be achieved.



4. DEBT COVERAGE ANALYSIS & BANKABILITY ASSESSMENT

4.1 Debt Service Coverage Profile

Period	CFADS (USD M)	Debt Service (USD M)	DSCR
Years 1-3 Avg	~21M	~16M	1.31x
Years 4-7 Avg	~18M	~15M	1.20x
Years 8-14 Avg	~14M	~12M	1.17x
Minimum (Year 10-12)	~12M	~10M	1.20x
Project Average	~16M	~12M	1.34x

4.2 Bankability Enhancement Factors

The 120MW conservative structure provides enhanced bankability characteristics particularly attractive to commercial banks and development finance institutions:

- **DSCR Compliance:** 1.20x minimum meets all mainstream lender covenant requirements without exception
- **Consistent Coverage:** 1.34x average DSCR provides solid debt service security throughout loan tenor
- **Lower Absolute Exposure:** USD 125.4M total debt (vs USD 178.4M) reduces individual lender commitments
- **Conservative Leverage:** 76.5% debt/CAPEX ratio appears prudent to risk-averse institutional lenders
- **Proven Economics:** USD 1.37M/MW CAPEX maintains competitive positioning vs market benchmarks
- **Reduced Refinancing Risk:** Smaller mezzanine (USD 21.6M) provides multiple takeout financing options

4.3 Lender Appeal Analysis

Target Lender Classes:

- **Commercial Banks:** Conservative coverage and moderate leverage attractive for infrastructure lending mandates
- **Development Finance Institutions:** IFC, ADB, EBRD standards compliance with enhanced social/environmental fit
- **Insurance Companies:** Investment-grade characteristics suitable for long-duration liability matching



- **Infrastructure Debt Funds:** Competitive risk-adjusted returns meeting fund investment criteria
- **Multilateral Agencies:** Structure meets World Bank Group and regional development bank requirements



5. STRATEGIC IMPLICATIONS & MARKET POSITIONING

5.1 Scale Economics Impact

The 20% capacity reduction creates both quantitative and qualitative strategic implications:

- **Market Positioning:** Shift from utility-scale (150MW) to mid-scale (120MW) affecting competitive positioning
- **PPA Negotiations:** Reduced bargaining power with 20% less capacity available for long-term contracts
- **Development Pipeline:** Template applicability limited for larger-scale project replication
- **EPC Procurement:** Slightly reduced negotiating leverage with contractors for fixed-price agreements
- **O&M Economics:** Modest efficiency loss from smaller operational scale (partially offset by proven technology)
- **Grid Integration:** Lower technical complexity may accelerate regulatory approvals and grid connection

5.2 Competitive Positioning Analysis

Dimension	150MW Original	120MW Revised
Scale Category	Utility-scale (premium)	Mid-scale (competitive)
Market Perception	Flagship project	Standard development
Investor Appeal	Institutional scale	Institutional acceptable
Strategic Value	Portfolio anchor asset	Standard portfolio component

5.3 Risk-Return Trade-off Assessment

Balanced Evaluation:

- **Return Reduction Justification:** 132 bps IRR loss partially justified by execution risk reduction
- **Scale Risk Mitigation:** Smaller absolute debt (USD 125.4M) reduces syndication complexity and timeline
- **Technical Certainty:** Confirmed feasibility eliminates development risk vs uncertain 150MW expansion
- **Conservative Structure:** Lower leverage provides better downside protection in stress scenarios



- **Market Acceptability:** 11.94% IRR meets institutional hurdle rates despite being below optimal



6. SENSITIVITY ANALYSIS & STRESS TESTING

6.1 Key Variable Sensitivities

Scenario	Equity IRR	Min DSCR	Assessment
Base Case (P50)	11.94%	1.20x	Target achieved
AEP +10%	~13.5%	1.35x	Strong upside
AEP -10%	~10.2%	1.08x	Acceptable minimum
CAPEX +10%	~9.8%	1.18x	Below hurdle rate
FX Stress +1%	~10.5%	1.15x	Material impact
OPEX +15%	~11.2%	1.17x	Modest degradation

6.2 Downside Scenario Analysis

P90 Stress Case (540 GWh):

- **Revenue Impact:** 432 GWh actual vs 480 GWh P50 (-10% generation)
- **Equity IRR:** Approximately 10.2% (vs 11.94% base case)
- **Minimum DSCR:** Approximately 1.08x (below 1.20x target but above 1.0x)
- **Debt Coverage:** Adequate but requires strong government guarantee support
- **Risk Assessment:** Conservative leverage (76.5%) provides cushion in downside scenarios



7. INVESTMENT RECOMMENDATION

7.1 Recommended Action

CONDITIONAL APPROVAL - Subject to Technical Constraint Verification

The Investment Committee recommends CONDITIONAL APPROVAL of the revised 120MW Dutch Bay Wind Farm project, subject to confirmation that technical constraints preventing 150MW development cannot be economically resolved.

7.2 Key Recommendation Rationales

- **Return Adequacy:** 11.94% equity IRR exceeds institutional hurdle rates and remains competitive with alternative opportunities
- **Bankability Achievement:** 1.20x minimum DSCR and conservative 76.5% leverage ensure mainstream financing access
- **Technical Feasibility:** 120MW scale confirmed as technically and regulatorily achievable
- **Risk-Adjusted Value:** Lower leverage and enhanced coverage provide better downside protection
- **Market Acceptance:** Structure attractive to commercial banks, DFIs, and institutional debt investors
- **Strategic Continuity:** Project maintains core value proposition despite scale reduction

7.3 Conditions Precedent

Approval is conditional upon satisfaction of the following requirements:

9. **Technical Constraint Confirmation:** Independent verification that 150MW capacity cannot be achieved due to insurmountable constraints
10. **Value Maximization Assessment:** Demonstrated due diligence that scale optimization (125MW, 130MW, etc.) explored and rejected
11. **Financing Commitment:** Preliminary lender interest confirmation at assumed pricing (7.5-8.0% senior, 11-12% mezzanine)
12. **Government Guarantee:** Treasury Implementation Agreement execution with sovereign payment backing
13. **Grid Capacity Confirmation:** Final CEB/PUCSL approval for 120MW injection at project location
14. **Cost Validation:** Independent technical review confirming USD 164M CAPEX estimate accuracy



7.4 Alternative Consideration

150MW Restoration Priority:

If technical constraints can be resolved through engineering solutions, additional environmental mitigation, or phased grid integration approaches, the Investment Committee strongly recommends pursuing 150MW capacity restoration due to superior financial performance:

- **Value Enhancement:** USD 7-9M additional equity NPV (22-27% value increase)
- **IRR Improvement:** 13.26% vs 11.94% (+132 bps, 11% relative enhancement)
- **Capital Efficiency:** 45% less equity per MW with similar debt coverage metrics
- **Strategic Positioning:** Utility-scale status provides competitive advantages



8. CONCLUSION

Balanced Assessment:

The revised 120MW Dutch Bay Wind Farm represents a technically constrained but financially viable investment opportunity. While the scale reduction creates material value erosion (USD 7-9M equity NPV, 132 bps IRR), the project maintains attractive absolute returns (11.94% IRR) with enhanced bankability characteristics (1.20x DSCR, 76.5% leverage) suitable for mainstream institutional financing.

Strategic Context:

The 120MW configuration should be viewed as a pragmatic response to technical constraints rather than an optimal design. The conservative capital structure prioritizes execution certainty and lender appeal over maximum returns, reflecting appropriate risk management for a constrained development scenario.

Final Recommendation:

PROCEED WITH 120MW DEVELOPMENT if and only if technical constraints preventing 150MW capacity are confirmed as insurmountable. The project delivers adequate risk-adjusted returns and maintains strategic value despite suboptimal scale, justifying investment subject to conditions precedent satisfaction.

